

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

You have to choose your battles!



Learning Outcome

Describe necessity, duty, advice, or strong disapproval in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Are you good at making a compromise? Why or why not?
- What makes it hard to compromise?
- Do you think compromising is important sometimes? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about beliefs, and opinions, and express annoyance.
- I can report details, reasons, or results of events or actions.
- I can express willingness and refusal, and make promises and threats.





Let's Explore!

Jessica Tollens, a human resources **consultant***, gives a speech on the art of compromise.

* A "consultant" provides specific services to a company. Consultants are not normally employees of the company.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Good evening, everyone. So good to be here. I'm Jessica Tollens. If you will allow me, I'd like to start with a scenario. Imagine this: you are a dynamic person. You are planning to launch a new product. You've prepared the proposal, but your close colleague wants to make important changes before you sell it to the boss. You might think: "I can't believe it! This really makes me mad!" You might say to yourself: "I won't make any changes!" or "If this goes on, I will abandon the project!" In this situation, you have to come to a compromise.

You may be wondering where I got this 'situation' from. As a human resources consultant, I see situations like this one every day. Compromising can be difficult. It makes you feel like you have lost. It's important to know when to stand your ground, but also when to choose your battles. In this speech, I will give you some pointers to follow when a compromise is the best solution. Then, I will talk about some strategies for negotiating a good compromise. To prepare for this speech, I consulted my business partner on why compromising is important.

We believe that a compromise doesn't have to be equal to be acceptable. You need to ask yourself why is this something you should agree to. In my view, your ability to get things done at work almost always depends on the cooperation of other people.

I maintain that the best negotiators start by saying something positive like, "I value your leadership, and I would like to speak openly and honestly with you." This makes the other person feel that they are in a safe space, and they will be more likely to agree to a compromise.





Let's Practice!

Compromise is very important.

Instructions: Select the option that best completes each sentence.

- 1) We _____ that a compromise doesn't have to be equal to be acceptable.
a) believes
b) believing
c) believe
- 2) _____, your ability to get things done at work almost always depends on the cooperation of other people.
a) In my view
b) In my views
c) In my viewer
- 3) I _____ that the best negotiators start by saying something positive like, "I value your leadership."
a) maintenance
b) Maintain
c) maintaining
- 4) You may _____ : "I can't believe it! This really makes me mad!"
a) have think
b) think
c) thinks



Let's Practice!

Are you willing to do it?

Instructions: Use the words from the Word Bank to correctly complete the sentences.

Word Bank

won't make / will abandon / I'd like / If / you will /
compromise / will talk / will give

- 1) If _____ allow me, _____ to start with a scenario.
- 2) You might say to yourself: "I _____ any changes."
- 3) In this speech, I _____ you some pointers to follow when a compromise is the best solution.
- 4) " _____ this goes on, I _____ the project!"
- 5) I _____ about some strategies for negotiating a good _____.





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue of two people coming to a compromise.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, discuss situations that require two people to make a compromise.
- Select one situation.
- Write a dialogue of 12 - 15 lines.
- Use expressions from this lesson, such as *stand your ground* and *choose your battles*.
- Practice your dialogue.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a dialogue of 12 - 15 lines.

☐ ☐

I give suggestions for making a compromise.

☐ ☐

I respond to suggestions by giving my opinion.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **stand your ground** (expression): to resist something; be consistent with what you believe in
e.g. Compromising can be difficult. It makes you feel you have lost. It's important to know when to stand your ground.
- **cooperation** (noun): the action of cooperating (getting along) with other people
e.g. In my view, your ability to get things done at work almost always depends on the cooperation of other people.
- **negotiator** (noun): a person who negotiates or bargains to reach an agreement, such as a contract, with another person
e.g. The best negotiators start by saying something positive.
- **I can't believe it** (expression): this is crazy; unbelievable
e.g. You may think: "I can't believe it! This really makes me mad!"
- **choose your battles** (expression): select some things to fight for but ignore other things
e.g. It's important to know how to choose your battles at work and at home.





Learning Points

Wh-clause with Prepositions

You can use wh-clauses with prepositions.

Even though not all verbs require a preposition, you can form wh-clauses after prepositions.

- *I blamed my boyfriend for **why** we were late.*
- *My father replied to **what** my mother said.*

If a verb in the wh-clause needs a preposition, it can come at the end of the wh-clause. In more formal language, the preposition can come before the wh-clause.

- *The doctor didn't know **what** the patient was suffering from.*
- *The doctor didn't know from what the patient was suffering.*
- *My mother never asked **which** school club I belong to.*
- *My mother never asked to **which** school club I belong.*

Examples:

- *You may be wondering where I got this 'situation' from.*
- *To prepare for this speech, I consulted my business partner on why compromising is important.*

Willingness, Refusals, Promises and Threats

You can use *will* and *would* to show willingness or refusal to do something, and make promises and threats.

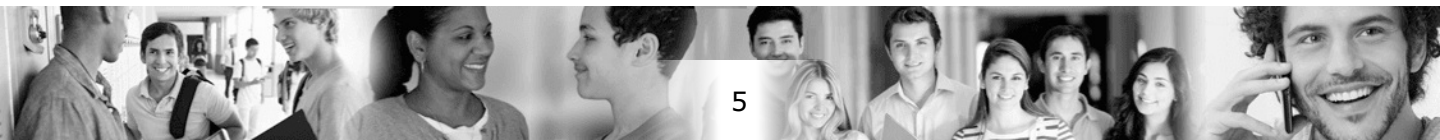
Look at the sentences below. What do you think they mean?

*I **will not wake up** early when I'm on vacation.*
*My friend **won't** ever **eat** at a restaurant alone.*
*Skype **won't work** without an Internet connection.*

***Will** you **help** me with my bags, please?*
***Would** you **give** him a message for me?*

*I **will try** my best to help you pass your exam.*

*If you don't do this favor for me, I **will tell** your mother that you stole \$50 from her last week.*





Learning Points

Look at the explanations below. Did you understand them correctly?

You use **will not** or **won't** to show that you don't want to do something. You are unwilling to do something and you refuse. Other people and things can also refuse.

- *I **will not wake up** early when I'm on vacation.* (I refuse to wake up early when I'm on vacation.)
- *My friend **won't** ever **eat** at a restaurant alone.* (My friend refuses to eat at a restaurant alone.)
- *Skype **won't work** without an Internet connection.* (Skype refuses to work without an Internet connection.)

If you want to ask someone if they are willing to do something, you can use **will** or **would**.

- ***Will** you **help** me with my bags, please?* (Are you willing to help me with my bags?)
- ***Would** you **give** him a message for me?* (Are you willing to give him a message for me?)

You can also use **will** to make a promise to do something in the future.

- *I **will do** my best to help you pass your exam.* (I promise to do my best to help you pass your exam.)

Will can also signal a threat if a promise has a negative result.

- *If you don't do this favor for me, I **will tell** your mother that you stole \$50 from her last week.* (Something bad will happen if you don't do this favor for me.)

Examples:

- *If you will allow me, I'd like to start with a scenario.*
- *You might say to yourself: "I won't make any changes!" or "If this goes on, I will abandon the project!"*

